

SUBIR HALDER



"There is a need to quickly institutionalise the learning from dealing with millets. There is a lot of innovation happening at various places and there has to be a mechanism for exchange of information and knowledge"

– **UMENDRA DUTT,** *Executive director, Kheti Virasat Manch*

WHAT INDIA NEEDS TO MASTER

In 2020-21, India had to repeal its agricultural sector reforms, which had the potential to deepen corporate-farmer relationships. Currently, uniform contract farming laws exist nationwide, but they impose restrictions on the movement of food articles. This presents challenges for corporations aiming to collaborate with farmers to cultivate processing-friendly food variants. Millets, however, can be cultivated through natural farming practices, though their revival is still in its early stages. Substantial investment is required in research and innovation to scale up production and maximise the gains from farmers' efforts. ■

THE CHANGE-MAKERS

ITC

- India's premier FMCG conglomerate is focusing heavily on the food processing business
- It continues to be the trend-setter for introducing newer products, bringing in technology and enhancing the capabilities of farmers from whom they source the raw material for their products

NETWORK OF COOPERATIVES AND FARMER PRODUCER ORGANISATIONS

- India is strengthening the deep network of these collectives, pushing them towards collective effort in procurement, storage and processing of the food

ANAND MILK UNION

- India's premier dairy co-operative sets the standards for milk products and now has a global footprint. The union has 18 members and procures approximately 26.3 million litres milk from 18,600 village milk cooperative societies and has 3.64 million milk producer members from the 33 districts of Gujarat. Amul has 26 categories of products, including butter, curd, cheese, ghee, beverages etc.